

Jothi Teaching Standards

PARENT COMMUNICATION STANDARD

Operational standard for communicating student progress clearly, professionally, and in a way that supports learning

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Document ID	JTS04 — Version 2.0
Publication Date	April 2026
Status	Current — supersedes JTS04 v1.0 (March 2026)
Intended Audience	Tutors, mentors, and academy leadership
Related Documents	JTS01 v2.0, JTS03 v2.0, JTS05 v2.0, JTD01 v2.0

1. Purpose

Parent communication is part of the learning system — not an optional extra. This standard defines what communication tutors are expected to produce, what it must be based on, and how it must be delivered. Poor communication weakens trust and misrepresents the student's actual learning position. Good communication creates an informed partnership that supports learning.

Linked competency: F1 (Communicating Progress to Parents). F1 is a JCT2 competency because it requires instructional maturity — evidence-based updates cannot be produced without first developing solid assessment and monitoring practice.

2. What Communication Must Be Based On

Every parent update should be grounded in specific learning evidence. Not general impression. Not recent mood. Not how much the tutor likes the student.

Acceptable Evidence Base	Not Acceptable
Lesson observations and diagnostic questioning outcomes	'She seems to be doing well' without specific lesson evidence
Test or assessment results with analysis of what they reveal	Reporting a mark without explaining what it means for understanding
Patterns in student reasoning, errors, or confidence	Impressions formed from a single lesson without noting consistency
Evidence of specific misconceptions addressed	Vague praise with no connection to actual learning behaviour
Progress or regression relative to a previous position	Speculation or concern not backed by specific observed behaviour

3. Types of Parent Communication

Type	When It Is Used	What It Must Include
Routine progress update	Periodically — not after every lesson	Topics covered. Current strengths. Areas needing reinforcement. Next priorities. Keep concise — two to four focused points.
Assessment-based update	After a test, topic review, or significant piece of work	What the student did well. What remains insecure. Whether errors are conceptual or procedural. What the next teaching focus will be.
Concern-based communication	When a meaningful concern has emerged	State the issue clearly. Explain why it matters for learning. Indicate what action is needed. Be timely — do not wait until the problem is serious to mention it.
Guidance and support message	When the parent needs to support the student more effectively	Specific, practical advice on revision focus, upcoming priorities, or preparation habits. Keep it actionable.

4. Tone and Professionalism

All parent communication must be clear, respectful, professional, and learning-focused. The following apply without exception.

Required	Not Permitted
Polite and respectful in all circumstances	Overly casual or informal language — especially in written communication
Honest about concerns without being alarmist	Emotional language or personal judgements about the student
Clear enough for a non-specialist parent to understand	Technical jargon without explanation
Focused on learning and next steps	Speculative claims or criticism not supported by lesson evidence
Using approved communication channels only	Direct messaging through personal apps, social media, or unapproved platforms

5. Channels and Boundaries

- Use only the communication channels and platforms approved by Johti Learning.
- Keep all communication focused on academic matters and agreed support — not personal topics.
- Maintain professional boundaries. Even if the relationship with the family is warm, communication must remain professional in content and tone.
- Escalate unusual or difficult parent interactions through the correct internal channels. Do not attempt to manage complex situations alone.

- Under-18 tutors must not communicate directly with parents. This must be handled by an adult mentor or academy leadership.

Confidentiality

Handle all student information carefully. Share learning-related information only with authorised individuals through approved channels. Describe student performance respectfully — even when discussing concerns.

6. Supporting Student Motivation

Communication with parents should support the student — not undermine their confidence or create blame. When reporting difficulty, frame it in terms of the learning challenge and the plan to address it — not as a character judgment.

- Acknowledge real progress honestly — including small but significant improvements.
- Treat mistakes as a normal part of learning when discussing them with parents.
- Make next steps clear so parents and students know what to do, not just what is wrong.
- Avoid language that labels the student negatively. Describe the behaviour or the gap — not the person.

7. Common Communication Errors

Error	Why It Matters
Vague updates with no real information	'He is making good progress' tells the parent nothing useful. It wastes the communication and builds false confidence.
Reporting marks without explaining understanding	An 80% mark tells the parent nothing about what their child understands or what still needs work.
Raising concerns too late	If a pattern has been visible for three weeks, the parent should not be hearing about it for the first time when it has become serious.
Communicating outside approved channels	Creates compliance risk for the academy and removes the professional boundary that protects both tutor and family.
Focusing only on problems	Communication that only reports difficulty damages motivation and trust. Genuine progress should be named alongside areas for improvement.
Over-reassurance with no substance	Telling parents everything is fine when assessment evidence shows otherwise is misleading and a disservice to the student.

8. Version Notes — Changes from v1.0

Change	Reason
Evidence base table with acceptable/not acceptable columns added	v1.0 described the importance of evidence-based communication in prose. The table gives tutors a direct comparison they can check their communication against.
Four communication types presented in a table with required content	v1.0 described communication types without specifying what each must include. v2.0 adds required content per type.
Tone table with required/not permitted columns	v1.0 described professionalism across multiple paragraphs. The table is faster to use as a pre-send checklist.
Under-18 boundary made explicit	New in v2.0. Under-18 tutors must not communicate directly with parents. This was an operational gap in v1.0.
F1 competency code linked throughout	All references updated to use the A-F competency taxonomy from JTD01 v2.0.
Repetitive framing on 'why communication matters' removed	v1.0 made the case for good parent communication across multiple sections. v2.0 states the purpose once and gets to the standard.

Jothi Learning — United Kingdom

JTS04 v2.0 — April 2026